

`man man`

`man man` will bring up the manual entry for the `man` command, which is a good place to start!

`man intro`

`man intro` is especially useful. It displays the Introduction to User Commands, which is a well-written, fairly brief introduction to the Linux command line.

There are also `info` pages, which are generally more in-depth than `man` pages. Try `info info` for the introduction to `info` pages.

Searching for Man Files

If you aren't sure which command or application you need to use, you can try searching the man files.

`man -k foo`

This will search the man files for "foo." Try `man -k nautilus` to see how this works.

Note

`man -k foo` is the same as the `apropos` command.

`man -f foo`

This searches only the titles of your system's man files. Try `man -f gnome`, for example.

Note

`man -f foo` is the same as the `whatis` command.

Using Wildcards

Sometimes you need to look at or use multiple files at the same time. For instance, you might want to delete all `.rar` files or move all `.odt` files to another directory. Thankfully, there are series of wildcards you can use to accomplish this.

- * will match any number of characters. For example, `*.rar` will match any file with the ending of `.rar`
- ? will match any single character. For example, `?.rar` will match `a.rar` but not `ab.rar`
- [characters] will match any of the character within the brackets. For example, `[ab].rar` will match `a.rar` and `b.rar` but not `c.rar`